TOPIC 1 · INTRODUCTION TO CYBER HYGIENE

8 minutes · meaning and importance of cyber hygiene · everyday cyber risks · why habits matter

What is it?

Cyber hygiene is the set of small, regular habits that keep your phone, accounts, money and personal data safe — just as washing hands keeps germs away. It is not a one-time setting; it is a routine.

Most frauds in India do not "hack" a system. They trick a person into giving away an OTP, a PIN, a password or access to a phone. Good habits close those doors before anyone knocks.

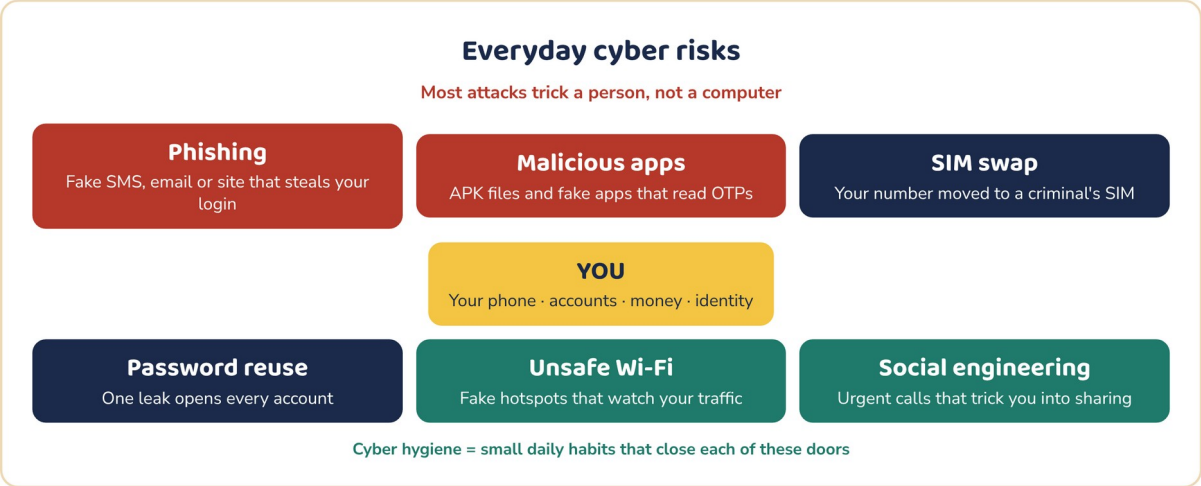


Figure 1.3 · Six everyday risks that cyber hygiene protects against

Key term	Meaning
Cyber hygiene	Simple, regular habits that protect devices, accounts and personal data
Social engineering	Tricking people with urgency, fear or greed instead of breaking technology
Phishing	A fake message, call or website that pretends to be trusted in order to steal details

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Figure 1.4 · The digital identity chain

Real-life case · Ravi, a student in Thane

A shopping site Ravi once used was breached. Criminals tried his leaked email and password on Instagram and Gmail — they worked, because he used the same password everywhere. Within an hour his friends received "urgent" requests for money from his account.

Lesson: one reused password turned one leak into three takeovers. Unique passphrases and two-step verification would have stopped it.

Ask yourself

- Am I careful when clicking links, downloading files or sharing information online?
- Do I use the same password for more than one important account?
- Is two-step verification on for my WhatsApp, email and banking apps?

Stop	Save	Report
Stop interacting with anything suspicious: do not reply, click or forward.	Screenshot the message, number, link and time before deleting anything.	Suspicious call or SMS: Chakshu on sancharsaathi.gov.in. Money lost: 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in.

Remember

Your OTP, UPI PIN, CVV, password and WhatsApp code are keys, not information. No bank, police officer or company will ever ask for them.

Trainer note

Open with a show of hands: "Who has received a message saying your account will be blocked?" It removes shame and makes the topic personal. Correct the myth "I have nothing worth stealing": your contacts and their trust are worth stealing.

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TOPIC 2 · PASSWORD AND ACCOUNT SECURITY

12 minutes · weak vs strong passwords · unique passwords · password managers · MFA · suspicious logins · recovery

What is it?

A weak password is short or personal (a name, a birth year, 12345678). A strong one is long, random and used for only one account. A **passphrase** of four random words is both strong and easy to remember.

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) adds a second check after the password: a code from an app, a prompt on your phone, a passkey or a fingerprint. Even if a password leaks, the account stays locked.

Build a strong passphrase

Long and random beats short and complex

Mango	+	River	+	Train	+	Blue	=	Mango-River-Train-Blue
random word 1		random word 2		random word 3		random word 4		easy to remember, hard to guess

Example	Why	Strength
ravi1998	Name + birth year: guessed from social media	Weak
P@ssw0rd!	Common pattern with symbols: on every attacker list	Weak
Mango-River-Train-Blue	Four random words, 20+ characters, unique to one account	Strong
Passkey / fingerprint sign-in	No password to steal or phish	Strongest

Figure 1.5 · Building a strong passphrase

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Figure 1.6 · How multi-factor authentication blocks a stolen password

Tool or setting	What it does	Where to set it
Password manager	Creates and remembers a unique password for every account; you remember one strong master passphrase	Built into Google and Apple accounts, or a reputable manager app
Passkey	Signs you in with fingerprint or face; nothing to phish	Google, Apple and many banking and shopping sites
WhatsApp two-step verification	Asks for your own 6-digit PIN when the number is registered on a new phone	WhatsApp → Settings → Account → Two-step verification
Google 2-Step Verification	Adds a prompt or code at sign-in	myaccount.google.com → Security
Recovery details	Lets you regain the account if locked out	Keep recovery phone and email current; store backup codes offline

Suspicious login alert? Act in this order

1 Do not click the link in the alert · 2 Open the official app and check login activity · 3 Log out unknown sessions · 4 Change the password from a safe device · 5 Turn on MFA · 6 Warn contacts if messages were sent in your name.

Trainer note

Run the passphrase game: groups invent a passphrase on paper, then the room tries to guess one word from its owner's social media. Demonstrate two-step verification on a demo account only.

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TOPIC 3 · DEVICE SECURITY AND APP PERMISSIONS

12 minutes · screen locks · updates · trusted app sources · camera, microphone, contacts and location permissions

What is it?

Your phone holds bank apps, photos, contacts and OTPs. Device security rests on four building blocks: a **screen lock**, **updates**, apps from **trusted sources only**, and **minimum permissions**.

A **permission** is an app's request to use the camera, microphone, contacts, location, SMS or files. Give each app only what it needs to do its job. An app installed from a link (an APK file) can read OTPs and mirror your screen.

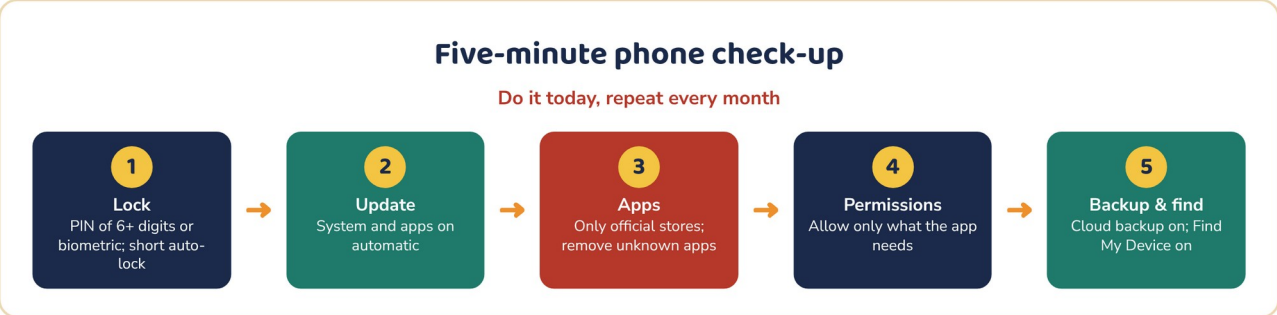


Figure 1.7 · The five-minute phone check-up

Building block	Why it matters	Good practice
Screen lock	An unlocked phone lets anyone read OTPs or open UPI	6-digit PIN or biometric; auto-lock within 30 seconds
Updates	Updates close security holes that criminals already know about	Automatic updates on for the system and apps
Trusted sources	Fake apps and APK files carry malware	Install only from Google Play or the App Store; check the developer name

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Which permissions make sense?

Green: needed · Amber: only while using / when asked · Red: refuse and ask why

App	Camera	Microphone	Location	Contacts	SMS
Torch / calculator	🔴	🔴	🔴	🔴	🔴
Maps	🔴	🔴	🟢	🔴	🔴
Camera app	🟢	🟢	🟡	🔴	🔴
Banking / UPI app	🟡	🔴	🟡	🟡	🟢
Messaging app	🟢	🟢	🟡	🟢	🟡
Free game	🔴	🔴	🔴	🔴	🔴

Banking apps may read SMS only to verify your own number; never give SMS access to games or torches

Figure 1.8 · Permission traffic light

Phone	Where to review permissions (menu names vary by brand and version)
Android	Settings → Security and privacy → Privacy → Permission manager; also Settings → Apps → [app] → Permissions
iPhone	Settings → Privacy & Security → choose Camera, Microphone, Location Services, Contacts

Ask yourself

- Is my phone protected with a screen lock that is not easy to guess?
- Are automatic updates switched on?
- Does every app have only the permissions it really needs?

Stop	Save	Report
Phone hot, slow, unknown apps or OTPs you did not request? Switch on airplane mode.	Note the app name and when it was installed; screenshot unusual activity.	Remove the app; change passwords from another device; report money loss on 1930.

Remember

Keep your devices secure and allow applications access only to the features they genuinely need.

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TOPIC 4 · PRIVACY AND PERSONAL INFORMATION

10 minutes · personal and sensitive information · digital footprint · social media privacy · safe sharing of photos and location

What is it?

Personal information identifies you (name, phone, address, date of birth, photos). **Sensitive information** can cause serious harm if misused (Aadhaar, PAN, bank details, health records). Your **digital footprint** is everything about you online — what you post, what others post and what apps collect.

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, you have the right to know how your data is used, to correct it, to ask for its erasure and to complain to the organisation and then the Data Protection Board.



Figure 1.9 · The information traffic light

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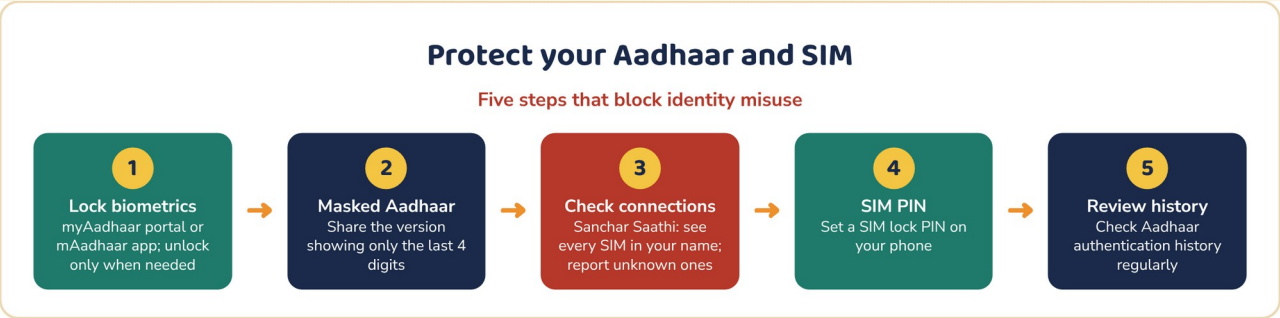


Figure 1.10 · Five steps to protect your Aadhaar and SIM

Platform	Privacy setting to check
WhatsApp	Settings → Privacy: profile photo, last seen and about to "My contacts"; groups to "My contacts"; turn on Silence unknown callers
Instagram / Facebook	Private account; limit who can tag you; switch off location on posts; review apps connected to the account
Phone gallery and camera	Turn off location tagging on photos before sharing
Google account	myaccount.google.com → Data and privacy: review activity controls and location history

Real-life case · The family trip post

Neha posted a week-long holiday with live location while her house in Pune stood empty. A neighbour's CCTV later showed strangers checking the door. **Lesson:** share trips after you return, switch off live location on posts, and keep the account private.

Remember

Your digital footprint can stay online for years. Think before you share, and share sensitive documents only in masked form and only for a verified need.

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TOPIC 5 · SAFE INTERNET PRACTICES

10 minutes · public Wi-Fi · public and shared devices · verifying websites · safe downloads · backups

What is it?

Safe internet use is about **where you connect, what you click and what you keep a copy of.** A fake website looks exactly like the real one; the difference is in the address and in how you arrived there.



Figure 1.11 · The 10-second website check

Term	Meaning
Look-alike domain	An address that imitates a real one by adding words or changing letters, such as sbi-kyc-update.in
Fake hotspot	A Wi-Fi network named like a café or station network, set up to watch your traffic

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Situation	Safer choice	Why
Banking or UPI while travelling	Use your own mobile data	You control the connection
Free Wi-Fi at a station or mall	Browse only; no banking or passwords	Others may watch the traffic or run a fake hotspot
Cybercafé or shared computer	Private window; never tick “remember me”; log out and close the browser	The next user can open your accounts
Downloading an app or file	Official store or the organisation's own website only	Links in messages often carry malware
Important photos and documents	Automatic cloud backup plus an offline copy	Backups defeat ransomware and phone loss
Phone lost or stolen	Block it through CEIR on Sanchar Saathi and lock the SIM	Stops misuse of the handset and number

Real-life case · Priya at the cybercafé

Priya logged in to her email on a cybercafé computer and left without logging out. The next user reset her social media passwords through her inbox. **Lesson:** private window, no saved passwords, log out, close the browser — every time.

Ask yourself

- Is the network I am using trustworthy?
- Did I check the full website address before entering details?
- Do I have a backup of my important files?

Stop	Save	Report
Entered details on a suspicious page? Stop and change that password from a safe device.	Note the website address, time and what was entered.	Inform the bank if card or UPI details were shared; report on cybercrime.gov.in.

Remember

Always verify before connecting, clicking, downloading or sharing information online.

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TOPIC 6 · BASIC CYBER INCIDENT RESPONSE

8 minutes · signs of compromise · immediate safe actions · preserving basic evidence · reporting channels · role of a First Responder

What is it?

A **cyber incident** is any event that harms or may harm someone's accounts, devices, money or safety. A **Community Cyber First Responder** gives first aid: identifies the risk, stops further harm, saves basic evidence and guides the person to the right channel.

You do not investigate the criminal, promise that money will come back, ask for the person's password or OTP, or take their phone without consent.

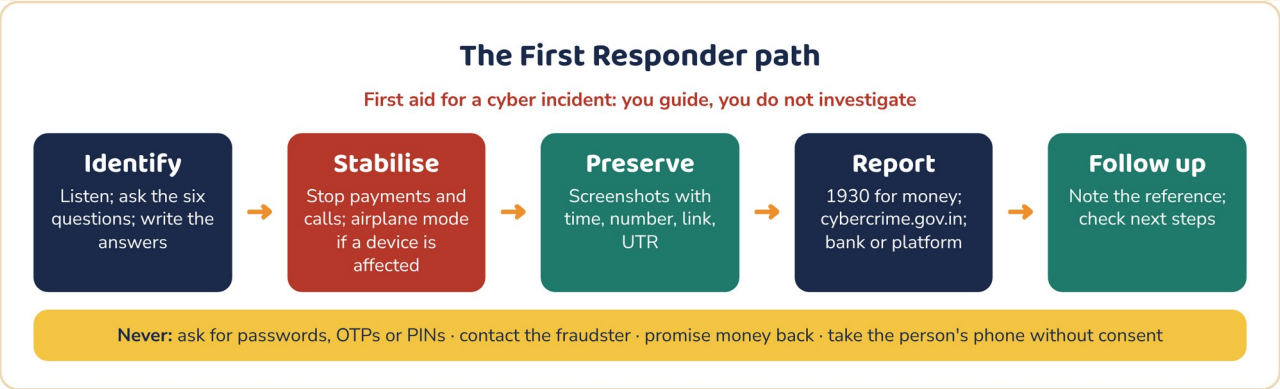


Figure 1.12 · The First Responder path

Ask	Why
What happened?	In their own words; do not interrupt
When?	Exact time; for money loss, the first hour matters most
Is money or data involved?	Decides whether 1930 and the bank come first
Is anything still happening?	New debits, calls or messages mean act now
Is anyone in danger?	Threats or a child involved: 112 / 1098 first
What evidence exists?	Screenshots, numbers, links, transaction IDs

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Figure 1.13 · Decision tree for the first action

Sign of compromise	What it may mean	First action
Login alert or OTP you did not request	Someone has your password	Check login activity in the official app; change password; MFA on
Friends receive messages you did not send	Account taken over	Recover via the app; warn contacts; report to the platform
Phone shows "No service" unexpectedly	Possible SIM swap	Call the telecom provider from another phone; alert the bank
Unknown app, fast battery drain, screen activity	Malware or remote access	Airplane mode; remove the app; change passwords from a clean device

Role limits

A First Responder identifies, stabilises, preserves and routes. Complex or high-risk cases go to the police, the bank, CERT-In (for organisations) or other authorised professionals. This is covered in depth in Modules 4 to 6.

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